

New DX11 benchmark

Stone Giant, a new DirectX 11 benchmark is launched

Q&A

A The screen problems might be to do with the monitor itself. If it's a 15 or 17-inch CRT, try setting the display resolution to 1024x768 or so.

For the Encarta problem, try uninstalling the .NET framework and reinstall it. Make sure your C: partition has enough space (2GB or more). If you think the system memory might be to blame, run Memtest86+ on your system to check for RAM errors.

Q Sparking screen

I have a Zenith laptop with a Core 2 Duo processor 2.00 GHz, 2 GB RAM and 320 GB HDD. I have a strange problem. A green line is sparking horizontally over the task bar of my desktop. I have consulted with the company as it was under warranty and they have changed the LCD. At first the problem went away, but after three days, the same line again started to spark at the bottom of my desktop. I have also formatted my hard disk and used Windows Vista Business but it hasn't fixed the problem. The line started to spark constantly when I played videos from my HDD, but otherwise, it sparks after a couple of minutes. Any solutions?

Ranjit Borah

A If there are actual sparks on the screen for whatever reason, then you need to take the laptop to the service centre again. If not, try booting into the BIOS screen and see if that flashing line still shows up. Then, you can rule out any software issues with Windows if at all.

Q Green dots everywhere

When I run a game, the game intro video plays but when I start to play the game, my system hangs. I re-installed my graphics drivers. My CPU heatsink isn't clogged with dust and every thing seems to be good. My Intel desktop manager shows good status on my components. I also removed and refit my card into the system.

Still, when I run a game, my system hangs with small green dots and inverted triangles on the screen. My problem seems to be different and difficult to resolve!

My configuration is as follows:

- Intel Core 2 Quad 6600
- Intel G33fb
- 4 GB DDR2 RAM
- 600W SMPS
- 500GB HDD
- NVIDIA GeForce 8800GT 512MB

Pranav Swaroop

A That memory hub controller temperature looks high. Green dots or any kind of grainy display is indicative of heating memory or graphics card. Shut the PC off, and quickly but very carefully, try touching the northbridge heatsink and then the graphics card heatsink. You'll know immediately if they're extremely hot. If the card is faulty or if the fan is running slow, then you need to have it repaired.

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